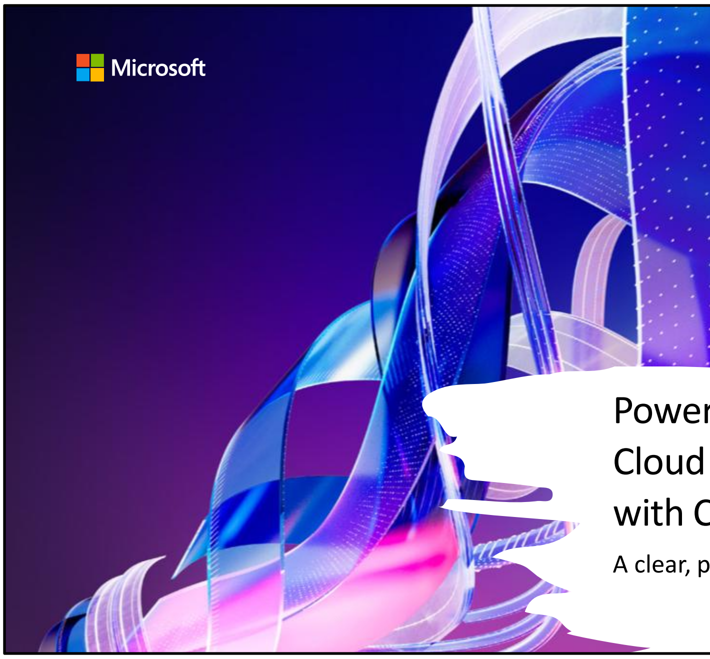


Powering dmg::media's Cloud Transformation with Confidence

A clear, proven path to scalable cloud success

How Microsoft's Platform Directly Delivers dmg's Priority Outcomes

Standardisation

Azure as the foundation

- A single, policy-driven platform for all brands - dmg can operate consistently across its portfolio, reducing fragmentation while still allowing individual brands to innovate within clear guardrails
- Approved landing zones and repeatable patterns reduce sprawl - New environments can be stood up faster and more predictably, lowering setup time and avoiding the long-term cost and risk of ad-hoc architectures
- Governance, security, and cost controls built in by design - Compliance and financial discipline are enforced automatically, reducing operational risk and avoiding retrofitting controls later under pressure.

Productivity

Fabric + automation

- One unified analytics platform (Fabric + OneLake) - dmg teams work from a single, trusted data foundation, eliminating duplication, reconciliation overhead, and conflicting insights across the organisation.
- Automation-first delivery removes manual effort and rework - Engineering and data teams spend more time on value-adding work, not repetitive operational tasks, increasing overall delivery capacity.
- Faster insight, experimentation, and time-to-value - dmg can test, learn, and respond to audience and commercial signals more quickly, improving decision-making speed in a fast-moving media environment.

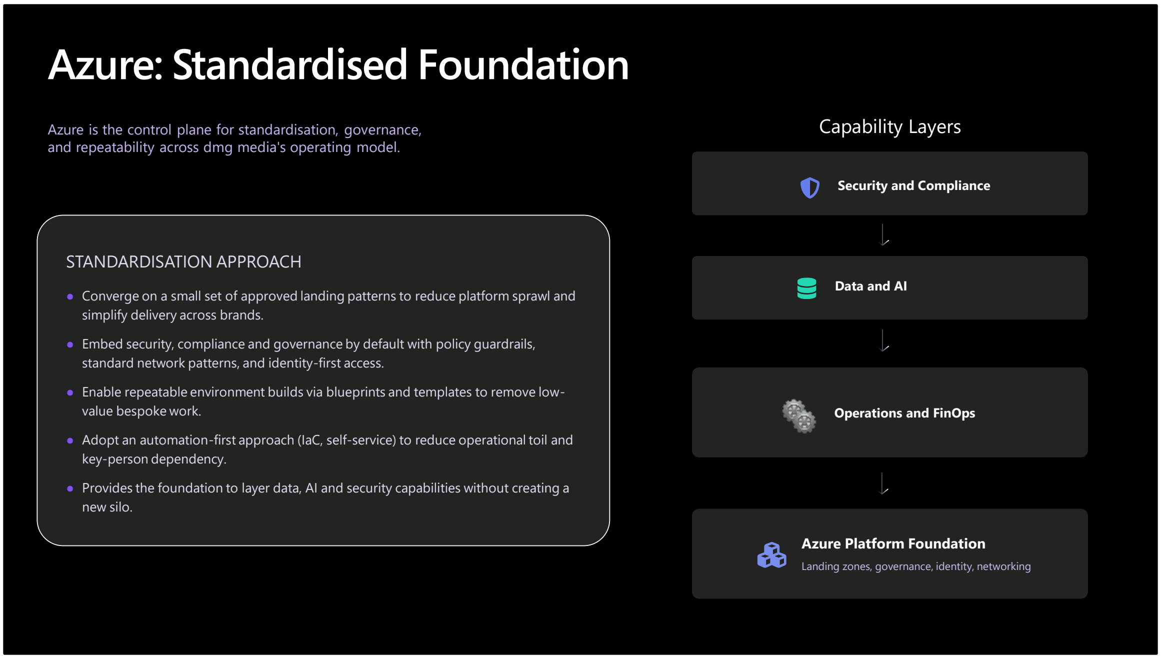
Risk Reduction

Security + UK-native resilience

- Integrated Zero Trust security across identity, data, and workloads - Security is consistently applied across all platforms and teams, reducing the likelihood and blast radius of security incidents
- UK-native disaster recovery (UK South / UK West) - dmg meets UK data residency and resilience expectations while maintaining continuity for critical services in the event of regional failure
- Repeatable resilience patterns, not bespoke designs per workload - Resilience becomes a standard capability rather than a bespoke cost, improving reliability while reducing design complexity and long-term support burden.

Bottom line: Azure provides dmg with a standardised, secure, and automation-ready platform that reduces risk today and accelerates outcomes over time.

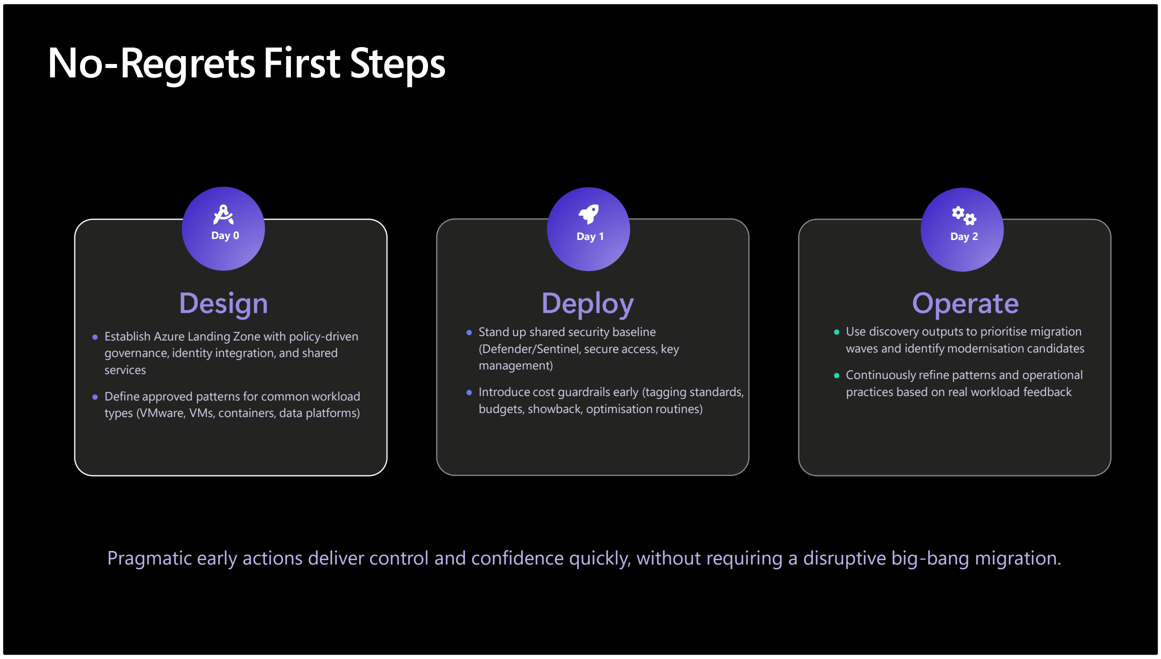
Content



This slide anchors the core Soft Perks message for DMG: Azure is not being selected simply as a hosting environment, but as a standardised control plane that directly supports DMG's business drivers of simplification, cost optimisation, and automation across brands.

Azure is not being positioned as simply a place to host workloads, but as the control plane for standardisation across dmg's estate. By converging on a small number of approved landing patterns, dmg reduces platform sprawl, simplifies delivery across brands, and avoids the long-term operational debt that comes from bespoke environments.
Security, compliance and governance are embedded by design through policy guardrails, standard network patterns and identity-first access, rather than being layered on later. This approach allows teams to move faster, because guardrails replace manual approvals.
The standardised foundation also enables repeatable environment builds through templates and blueprints, improving predictability and reducing reliance on individual experts. Importantly, this foundation is what allows data, AI, security and FinOps to be layered on later without creating new siloes.

The intent here is not to prescribe a single regional architecture, but to show that Azure provides DMG with predefined, repeatable patterns for sovereignty and resilience that can be applied consistently across workloads, reducing design effort and approval friction.



dmg can start realising benefits immediately, even before large-scale migration begins. The emphasis here is on pragmatic, no-regrets actions that deliver control and confidence early.

By establishing an Azure Landing Zone with policy-driven governance, shared services and identity integration, dmg puts the right foundations in place without forcing applications to move all at once. A small set of approved patterns for common workload types allows migration to proceed in waves, while still enforcing consistency.

Security and cost governance are deliberately introduced from day one, not deferred. This includes a shared security baseline and cost guardrails such as tagging, budgets and showback. Discovery outputs are then used to prioritise migration waves and identify modernisation candidates where it clearly reduces cost or operational burden.

UK/EU Footprint and Resilience

Azure's UK and EU region footprint directly addresses dmg's data residency and resilience requirements with transparent, repeatable patterns.

- Design for mandated UK data residency with London as the primary region, and clear options for EU workloads.
- Support resilient architectures using paired-region patterns and clear DR choices (including UK West).
- Make resilience a repeatable pattern with reference architectures and standard runbooks.
- Provide transparent operating and incident management processes.

Sovereignty and resilience are designed into the platform from the outset, not treated as special cases. Azure enables dmg to meet UK data residency requirements with London as the primary region, while retaining clear, repeatable options for EU workloads where required.

Resilience is addressed through standard paired-region patterns, with UK West available as a practical disaster recovery option where it best meets recovery expectations. The important point is that resilience becomes a reusable pattern, supported by reference architectures and runbooks, rather than something re-designed for each application.

This approach improves consistency, simplifies operational processes, and provides transparency around incident response and service management.

This slide responds directly to regional resilience and highlights a **meaningful, practical differentiator** in Azure's UK footprint.

Azure allows dmg to implement UK-only disaster recovery by using UK South as the primary region and UK West as the recovery region. This is a first-class regional pairing built into Azure's architecture — not an ad-hoc design choice.

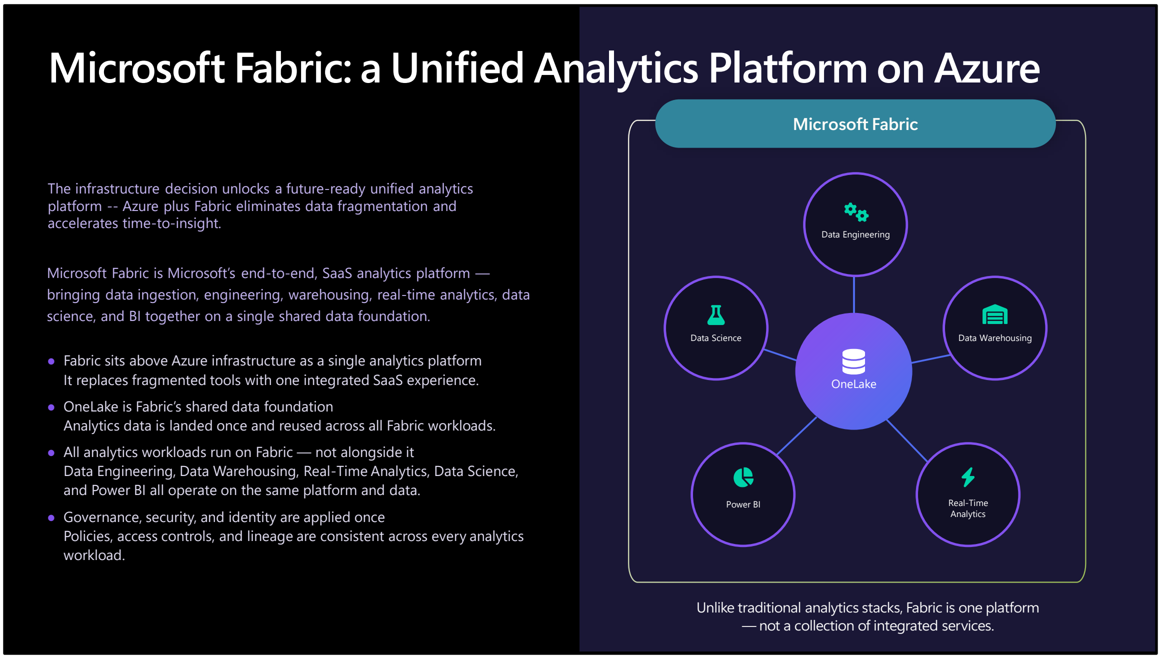
The key point is that dmg can achieve **strong disaster recovery objectives without needing to fail over to another country**. That means resilience does not come at the expense of data residency, regulatory simplicity, or governance confidence.

For many hyperscalers, equivalent resilience patterns require **cross-border recovery**, which introduces additional legal review, operational complexity, and risk. Azure's UK South / UK West pairing avoids that trade-off entirely.

This approach allows resilience to become a **standardised, repeatable pattern**, not something redesigned on a workload-by-workload basis. Runbooks, testing approaches, and automation can be defined once and reused consistently across applications.

The result is **operationally realistic resilience** — not just theoretical availability. Teams can regularly test recovery, document outcomes, and embed DR into normal operating processes.

Ultimately, this is a good example of how Azure aligns **sovereignty, resilience, and operational simplicity** together — and why UK-native disaster recovery is a genuine competitive advantage for dmg.

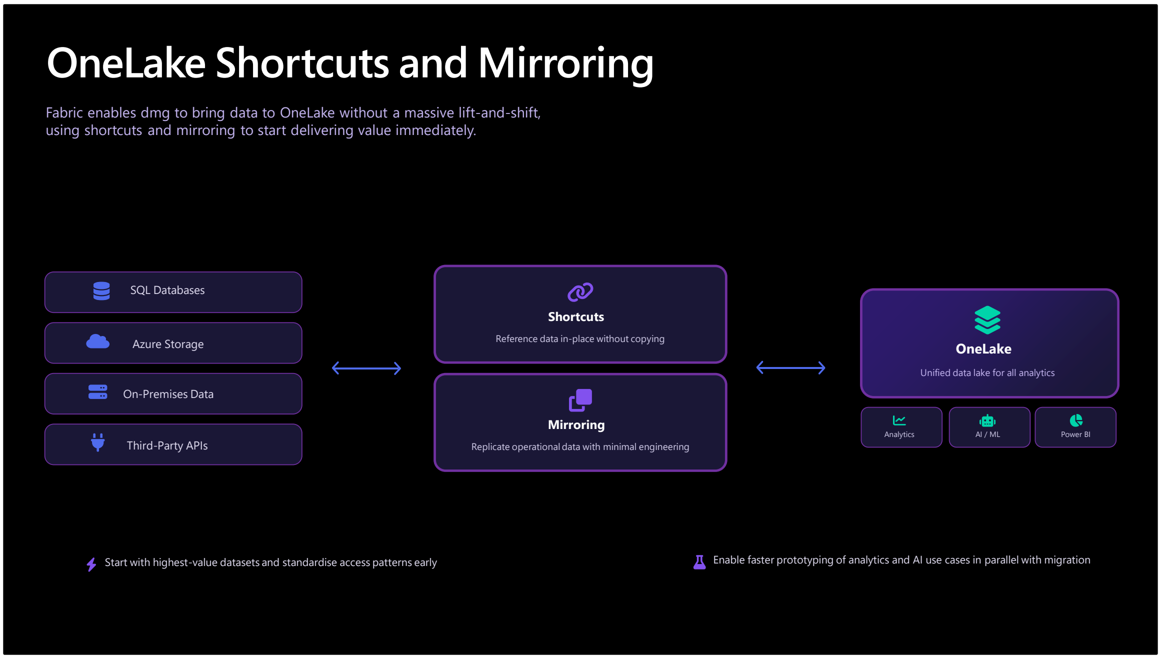


This slide clarifies what Microsoft Fabric is in practical terms for DMG: a single, SaaS analytics platform built on Azure, rather than a collection of loosely integrated services. The infrastructure decision therefore directly unlocks a simpler, more governable analytics operating model.

At the centre of Fabric is **OneLake**, which is the shared data foundation. Data is landed once and reused across all analytics workloads — Data Engineering, Warehousing, Real-Time Analytics, Data Science, and Power BI — without duplication.

The practical impact is reduced fragmentation, simpler governance, and faster time-to-insight. Security, access controls, lineage, and policy are applied once and inherited everywhere, rather than re-implemented per tool.

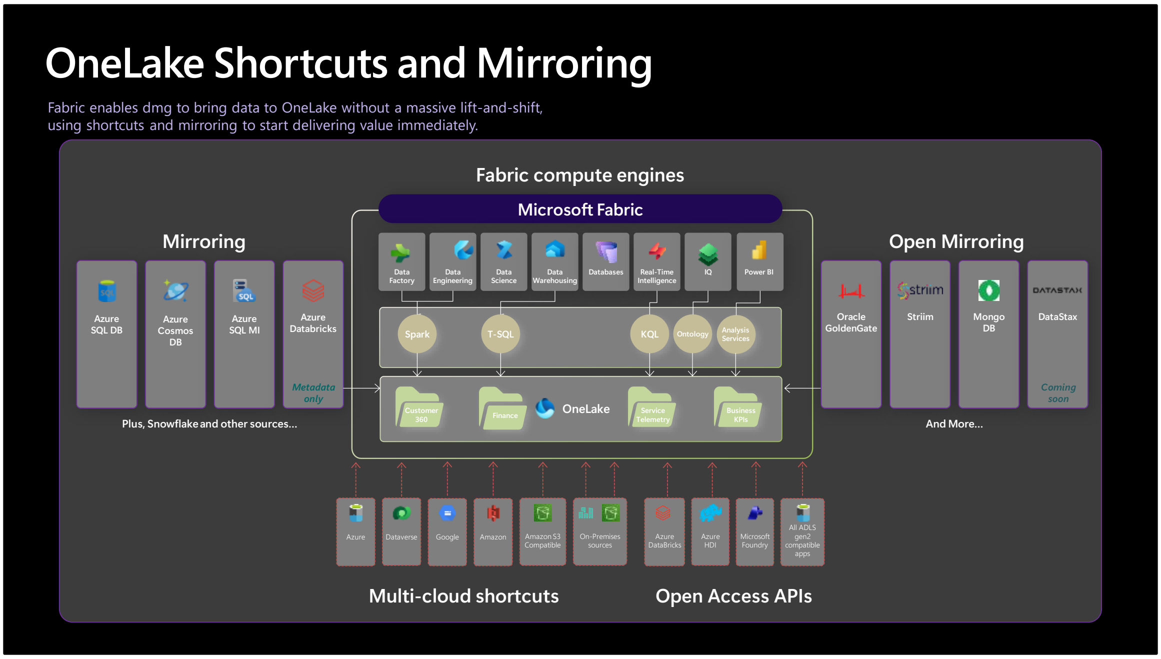
The key distinction is that Fabric is **not a collection of integrated services** — it is a single analytics platform. That's what allows dmg to move faster with less operational overhead while maintaining strong control.



Fabric is a pragmatic accelerator rather than a disruptive migration programme. OneLake shortcuts allow dmg to reference data where it already lives without copying it, while mirroring enables operational data to be replicated into OneLake with minimal bespoke engineering.

This approach avoids a “big bang” data migration and allows dmg to start with the highest-value datasets first. vernance and access patterns are standardised early, even while physical data movement proceeds gradually.

Crucially, this enables analytics and AI use cases to be prototyped and delivered in parallel with infrastructure migration, accelerating value and reducing programme risk.

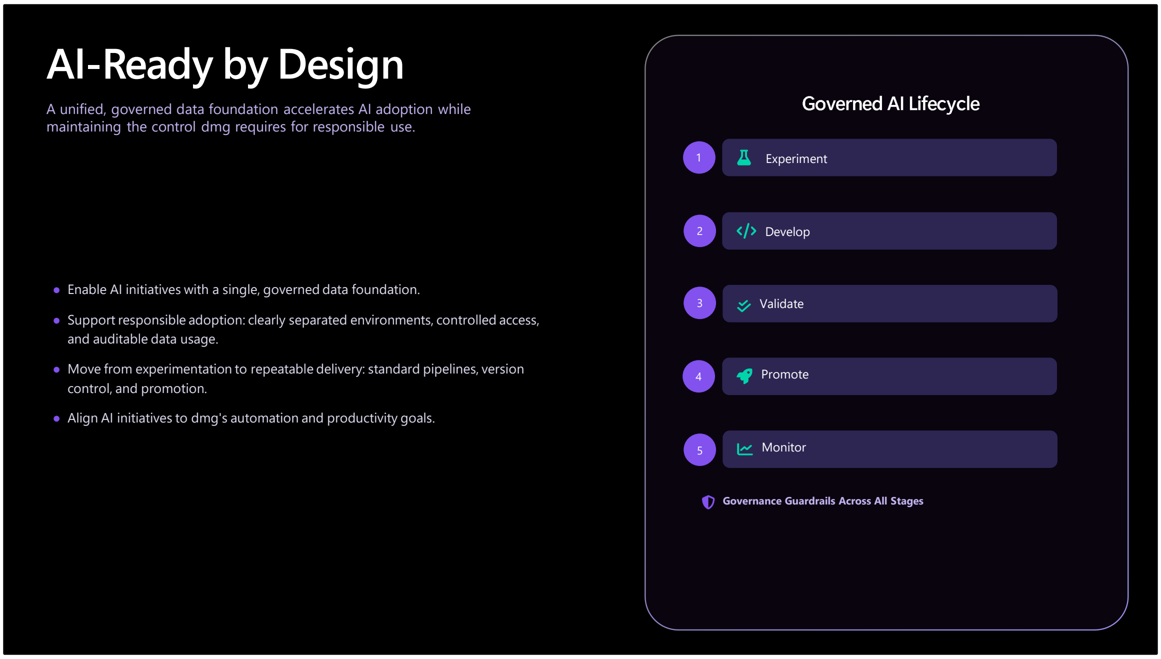


This slide is included as supporting evidence of Fabric's maturity and breadth, not as an expectation that DMG must adopt every integration shown. The key takeaway is that Fabric removes data silos and accelerates value by providing standard, platform-native mechanisms for bringing data into OneLake incrementally.

The modern data estate spans multiple clouds, accounts, databases, domains, and engines, making it hard to gain insights from your data. With Microsoft Fabric, we've simplified how you bring data into OneLake through two key Fabric capabilities: Shortcuts and a new data replication capability called Mirroring.

Shortcuts enable your data teams to virtualize data in OneLake without having to move and duplicate it. You can use shortcuts to combine your data—spread across different clouds, accounts, lines of businesses, and domains—into a virtualized data product tailored to your specific needs. We now have shortcuts for OneLake, Azure Data Lake Storage Gen2, Amazon S3 and S3 compatible sources, Microsoft Dataverse, and even on-premise sources. We also have Apache Iceberg shortcuts coming soon.

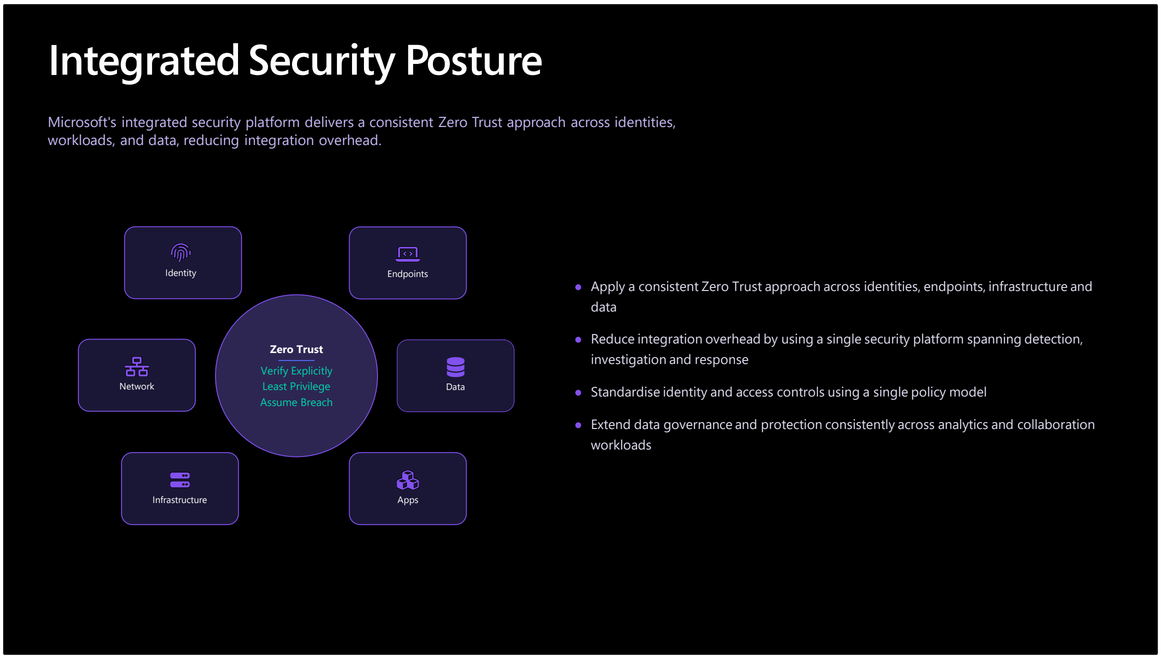
We are now have Mirroring, a frictionless way to add and manage existing cloud data warehouses and databases in Fabric's Synapse Data Warehouse experience. Mirroring replicates a snapshot of the database to OneLake in Delta Parquet tables and keeps the replica in sync in near real time. Once the source database is attached, features like shortcuts, Direct Lake mode in Power BI, and our universal security model work instantly. We currently have Mirroring enabled for Azure Cosmos DB, Azure SQL DB, and Snowflake with more coming everyday.



dmg can adopt AI faster precisely because governance is built-in. A single, governed data foundation removes duplication, access confusion and unmanaged experimentation.

Clearly separated environments, controlled access and auditable data usage support responsible AI adoption. Standard pipelines and promotion mechanisms allow teams to move from experimentation to repeatable delivery across development, test and production.

AI initiatives are deliberately aligned to dmg's automation and productivity goals, such as faster insight loops and more automated workflows, rather than being standalone experiments.

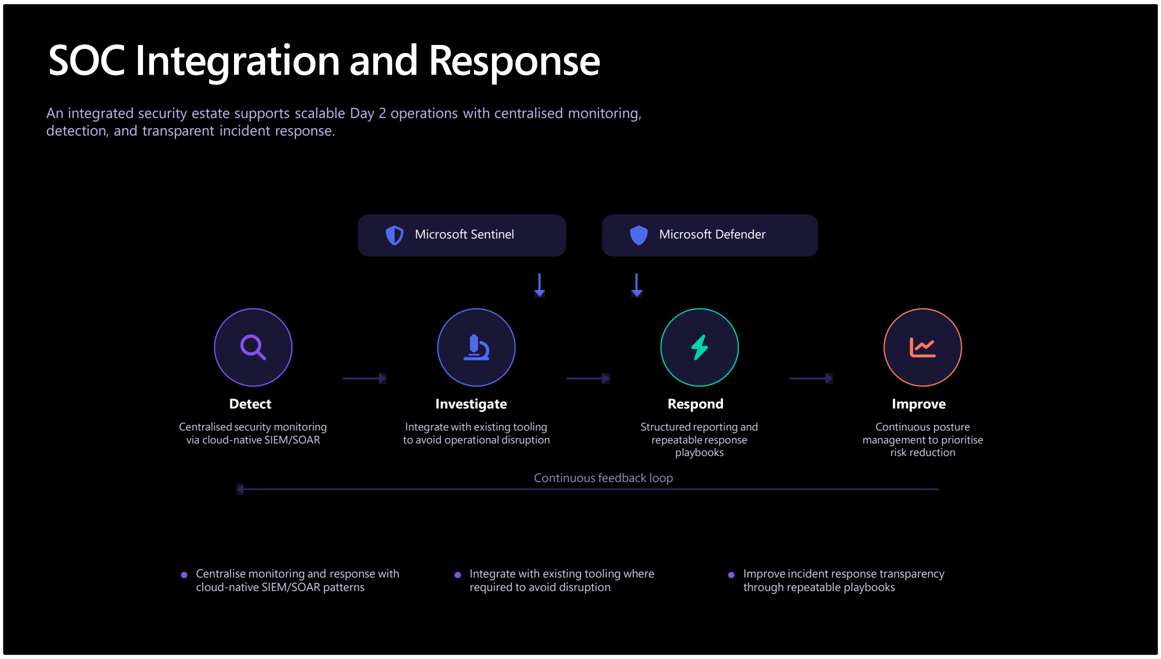


Security integration is a practical advantage rather than an overhead. A consistent Zero Trust approach spans identity, endpoints, infrastructure and data, reducing both risk and complexity.

Using an integrated Microsoft security platform reduces the need for multiple tool integrations and provides end-to-end visibility across the estate. Identity and access controls are standardised using a single policy model, including conditional and privileged access patterns.

Data governance and protection are extended consistently across analytics and collaboration workloads, supporting secure self-service rather than restricting it.

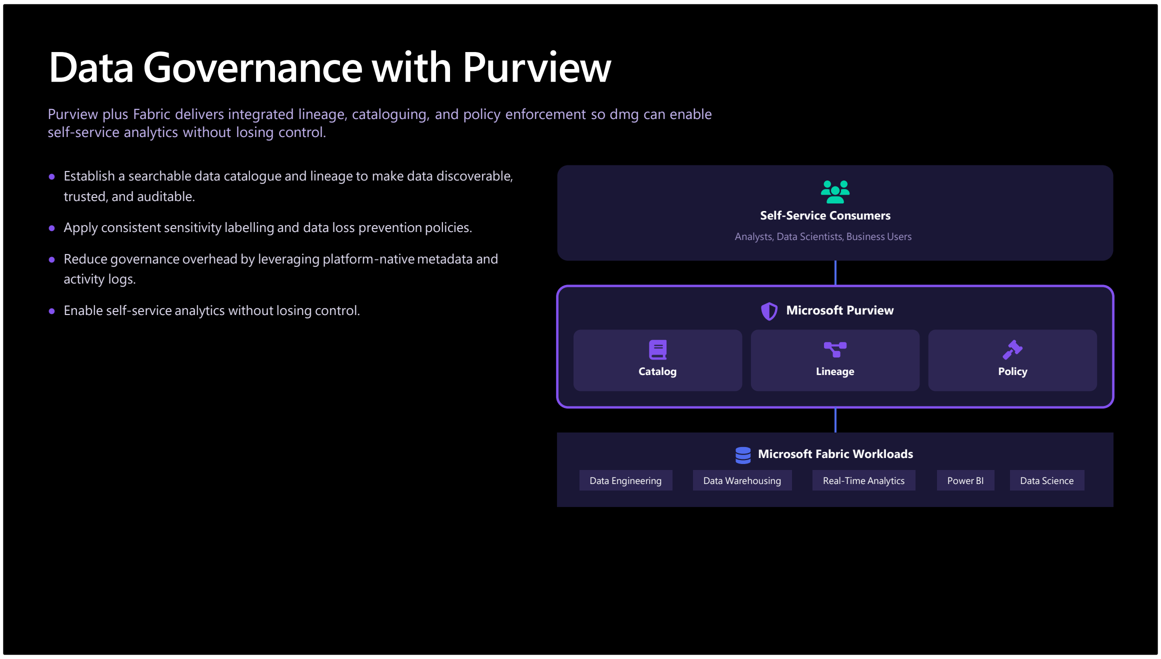
Because identity, threat protection, and data governance are delivered as a single platform, DMG avoids the integration complexity and operational overhead typically associated with stitching together multiple security tooling stacks.



Here the focus is on Day 2 operations. Centralising detection and response using cloud-native SIEM and SOAR patterns simplifies security operations and improves response times.

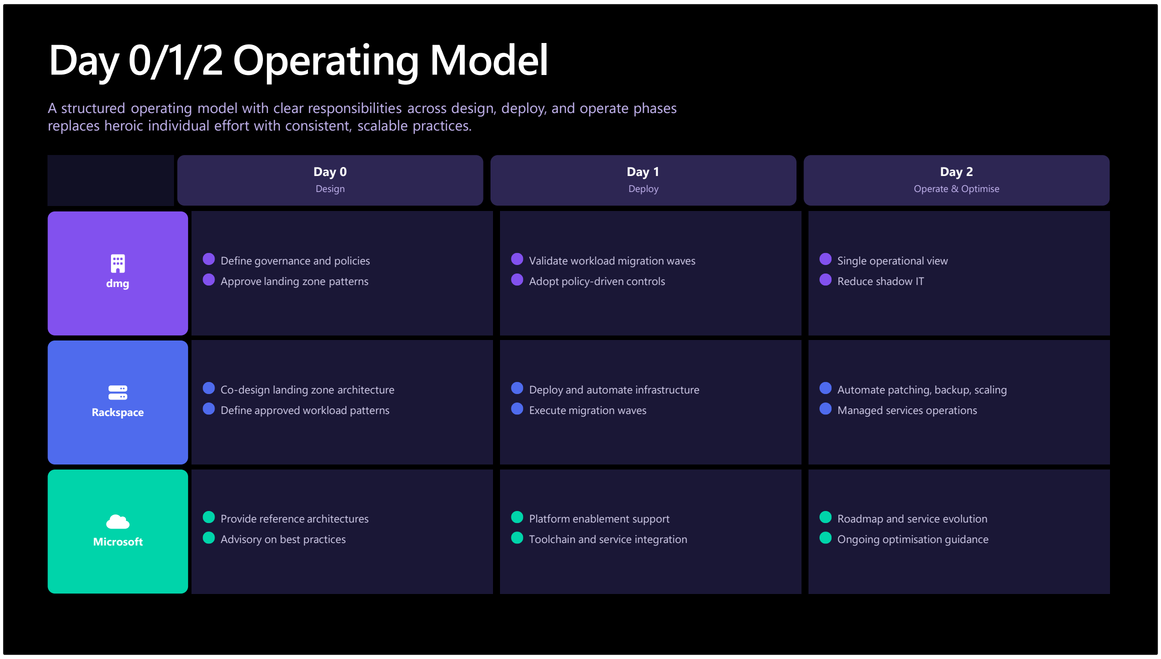
Where dmg already has existing tools, the model supports integration rather than forced replacement. Continuous posture management helps prioritise the risks that matter most, rather than reacting to individual alerts.

Structured reporting and repeatable playbooks improve transparency and consistency during incidents, reducing operational friction and escalation uncertainty.

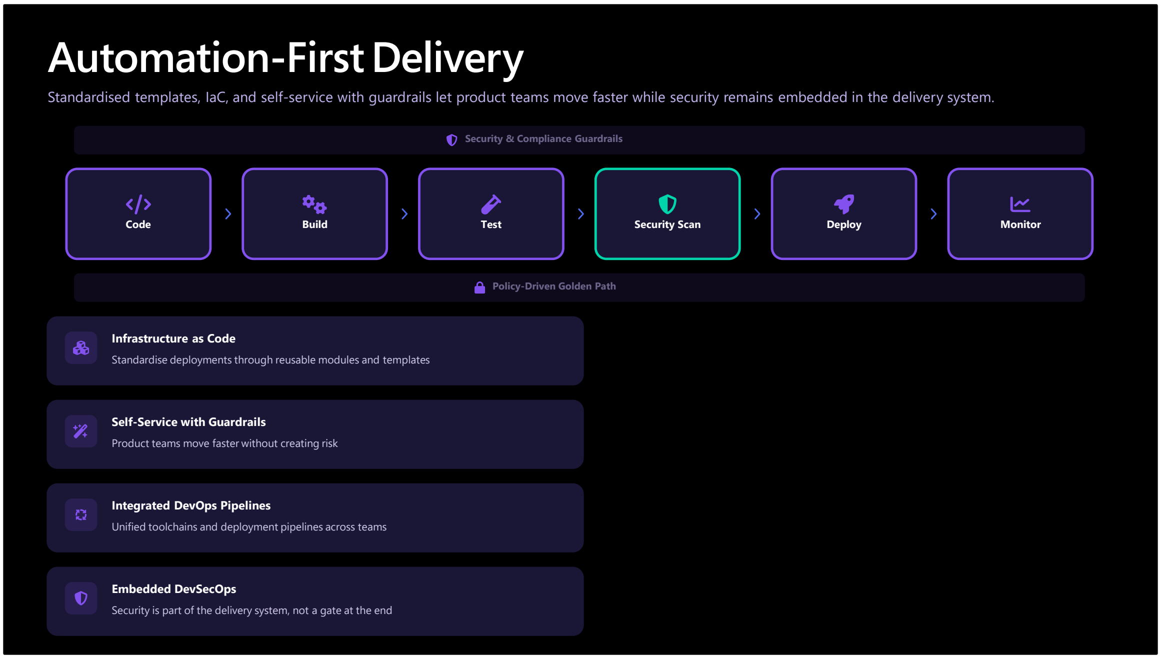


Governance becomes simpler — not heavier — when the platform is integrated. A searchable catalog and lineage make data discoverable, trusted and auditable. Consistent sensitivity labelling and data loss prevention policies are applied once and inherited across analytics assets. Platform-native metadata and logs reduce governance overhead while improving reporting.

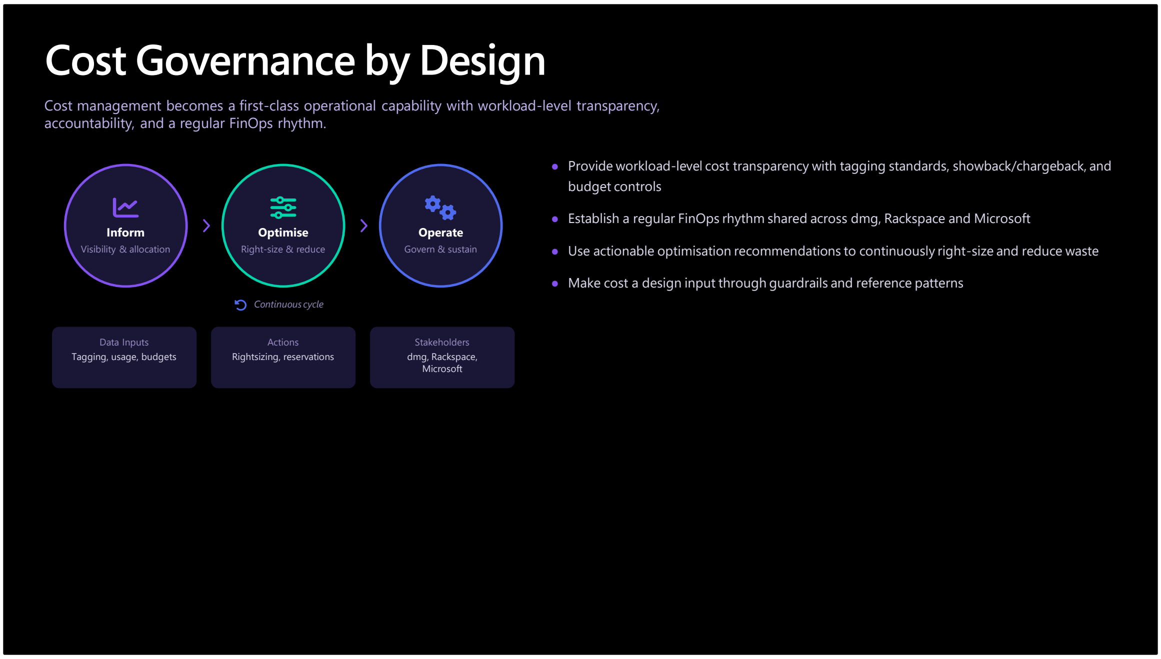
The result is self-service analytics with clear guardrails, enabling productivity without compromising control.



Addressing one of the biggest risks in cloud programmes: reliance on individuals rather than systems. Clear Day 0, Day 1 and Day 2 responsibilities define who designs, deploys and operates the platform.
Policy-driven controls reduce shadow IT and enforce standard patterns.
Automation of routine operations such as patching, backup and scaling improves service consistency and reduces toil.
A single operational view across monitoring, logging and incident management improves visibility and cross-team coordination.



Automation directly supports speed and safety. Infrastructure as Code and reusable modules reduce configuration drift and manual errors.
Self-service with guardrails enables product teams to move quickly without bypassing governance. Integrated DevOps pipelines support repeatable releases and automated promotion.
Security is embedded into the delivery system through DevSecOps practices, rather than added as a late-stage gate.

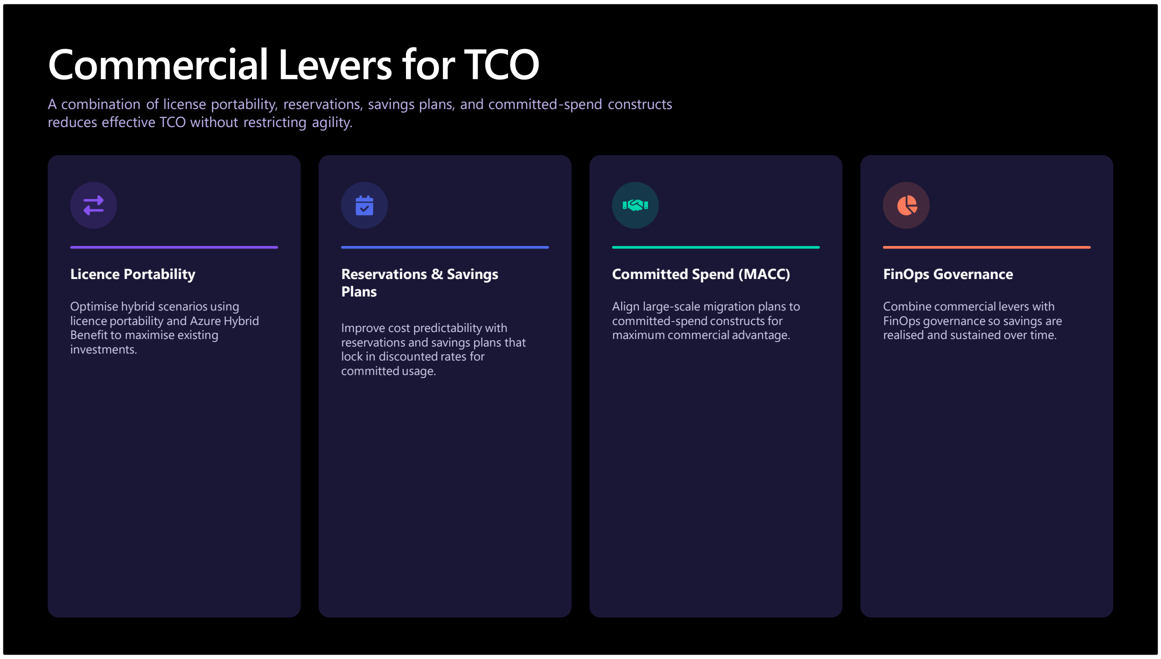


Cost management should be an operational capability, not a finance afterthought. Tagging, showback and budget controls provide workload-level visibility and accountability from day one.

A regular FinOps rhythm shared across dmg, Rackspace and Microsoft ensures optimisation is continuous, not ad hoc. Actionable recommendations convert cloud adoption into measurable savings.

Treating cost as a design input prevents unpleasant surprises later and supports sustainable growth.

Importantly, this governance model is what prevents cost regression over time, ensuring savings are sustained as the platform and subscriber base scale.



Commercial mechanisms available to dmg. Licence portability and hybrid benefits can be used where applicable to optimise hybrid scenarios. Reservations and savings plans improve predictability for steady-state workloads, while elasticity is retained for variable demand. Committed-spend constructs can be aligned to phased migration plans, supporting a multi-year data centre exit.

Crucially, these levers are governed through FinOps so savings are realised and sustained, not just modelled.

Option A: Lift-and-shift

- Option A provides an estimate for a strict, like-for-like re-host (lift-and-shift) response aligned directly to the snapshot dataset supplied by dmg, with no optimisation or architectural changes assumed.* (Assumptions shared in slide 21)

- Pricing is based on Azure Reserved Instances for steady-state workloads to deliver the strongest commercial outcome, while retaining flexibility through reservation exchange options should requirements evolve over time.

Option A - 3 Yr Reservation Instances		
Total Cost for each region (Compute + Disk + DB)	**Monthly**	**Annual**
UK South	**$ 171,520.69**	**$ 2,058,248.28**
North Europe	**$ 162,525.31**	**$ 1,950,303.72**
Germany West Central	**$ 161,325.66**	**$ 1,935,907.92**

- Please review the following document for more details on the ability to exchange Azure Reservations. Self-service exchanges and refunds for Azure Reservations - Microsoft Cost Management | Microsoft Learn

*** An assessment will need to be completed using Azure Migrate or Dr Migrate within the environment for full performance history and to refine cost estimate**

Option B: Microsoft Azure Consumption Commitment (MACC)

- Option B models a typical enterprise setup, blending commitment-based discounts with on-demand flexibility—using 30% Pay-as-you-go and 70% Reserved instances to reflect typical enterprise cost profiles*. (See slide 21 for assumptions.)

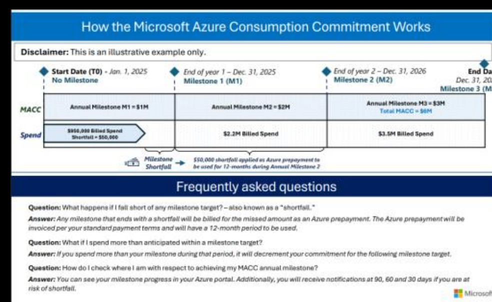
- $8.7M Milestone MACC Over 3 years contracted under the Microsoft Customer Agreement (MCA);
  - $1.7m is current consumption + $7m is the estimated cost to virtualise dmg's infrastructure estate.
- Azure Commitment Discount (ACD)
  - In return for the MACC over 3 years, MSFT will provide an 8% discount on all pay as you go 1st party services, including DMGs current workloads. ACD does not apply to Reserved Instances (RIs).
- Below is an illustration of the optimised costs across different regions.

Option B (30% PAYG + 70% RIs)		
Region	**Monthly**	**Annually**
UK South	**$ 218,999.63**	**$ 2,627,995.60**
North Europe	**$ 199,654.84**	**$ 2,395,858.05**
Germany West Central	**$ 206,053.05**	**$ 2,472,636.57**

- Azure commitments are aligned with adoption and optimisation services, delivered through **Unified,** to accelerate deployment and maximise value from the MACC. All MACCs must have a Unified attached. Details shared separately.

*** An assessment will need to be completed using Azure Migrate or Dr Migrate within the environment for full performance history and to refine cost estimate**

Additional Details on MACC



MACC Investment Levers

Microsoft

Investments

Direct Investment

ECIF (End Customer Investment Funding)	**ACO** (Azure Credit Offer)	**ACD** (Azure Commitment Discount)

Foundation

- A Consumption Plan
- B Deal Term Length
- C Spend Commitment: MACC

Definitions

Acceleration of workload migration to Azure	Offset "early in life" double run costs or ramp-up costs	Incentivize future workload migration and reduce Azure costs

- A Customer & MS **aligned** plan for growth on Azure
- B 3 years
- C Achievable growth underpinned by Consumption Plan

This is not an offer and does not create binding commitments. Funding requires approval; this slide only informs DMG of potential investment options.
Final terms will be those in the executed Commercial Licensing Agreement.

Azure Consumption Assumptions

The following assumptions were made during the sizing of this:

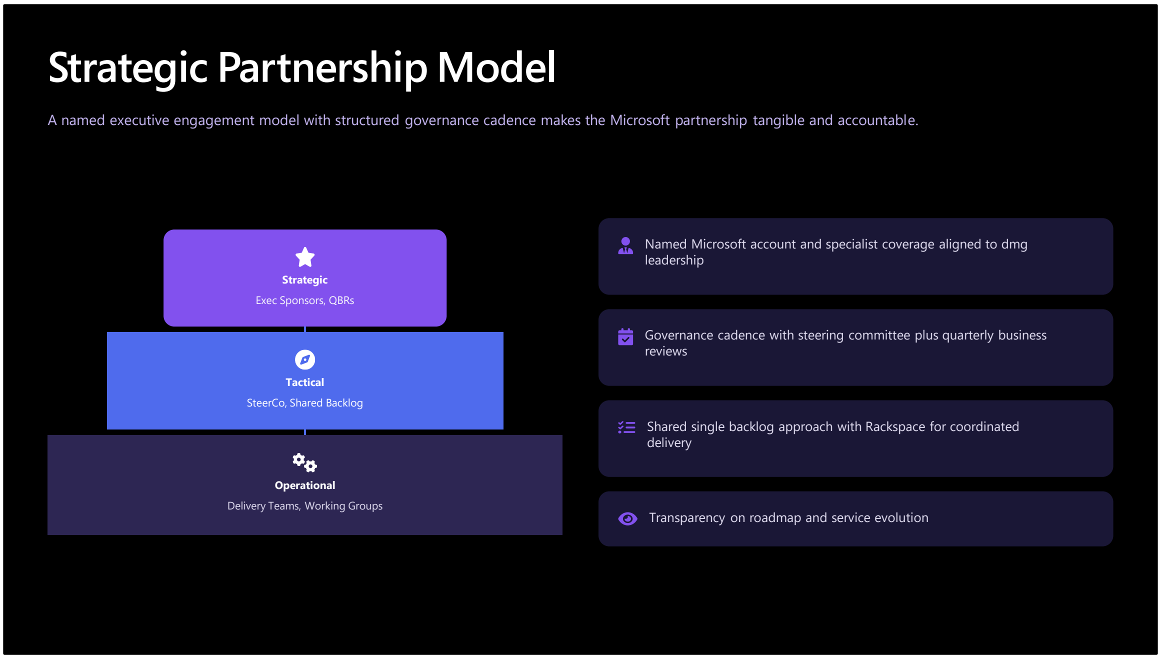
- Workloads are deployed using Azure Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS).
- SQL Server workloads are hosted on Azure Virtual Machines, not PaaS services.
- VM sizing is based on source CPU cores and combined OS + SQL memory, with no aggressive right-sizing applied.
- Storage is modelled using separate managed disks for SQL data and transaction logs, in line with standard SQL Server on Azure IaaS deployment patterns.
- Azure Hybrid Benefit is assumed for Windows Server and SQL Server, where applicable.
- 3-Year Reserved Instances are used to represent steady-state consumption; PAYG pricing is used to represent ramp-up and flexibility.
- Managed disk reservations are not assumed and may be evaluated post-migration.
- Ancillary services (Azure Backup, Azure Monitor) have not been included in RFP requirements and therefore not within our costings at this stage, however, should be reassessed and costed in discovery workshops to ensure optimised resiliency of solution.
- Option B includes a ratio of using 30% of the Pay-as-you-go pricing, while utilising 70% of Reservation instances to showcase a typical Enterprise cost profile

*** An assessment will need to be completed using Azure Migrate or Dr Migrate within the environment for full performance history and to refine cost estimate**

dmg has named Microsoft account and specialist coverage aligned to the programme, with clear executive sponsorship.

A regular governance cadence — steering committees and QBRs — manages priorities, escalations and value tracking. A shared backlog with Rackspace ensures delivery stays outcome-focused.

Roadmap transparency and structured access to product guidance support informed decision-making.



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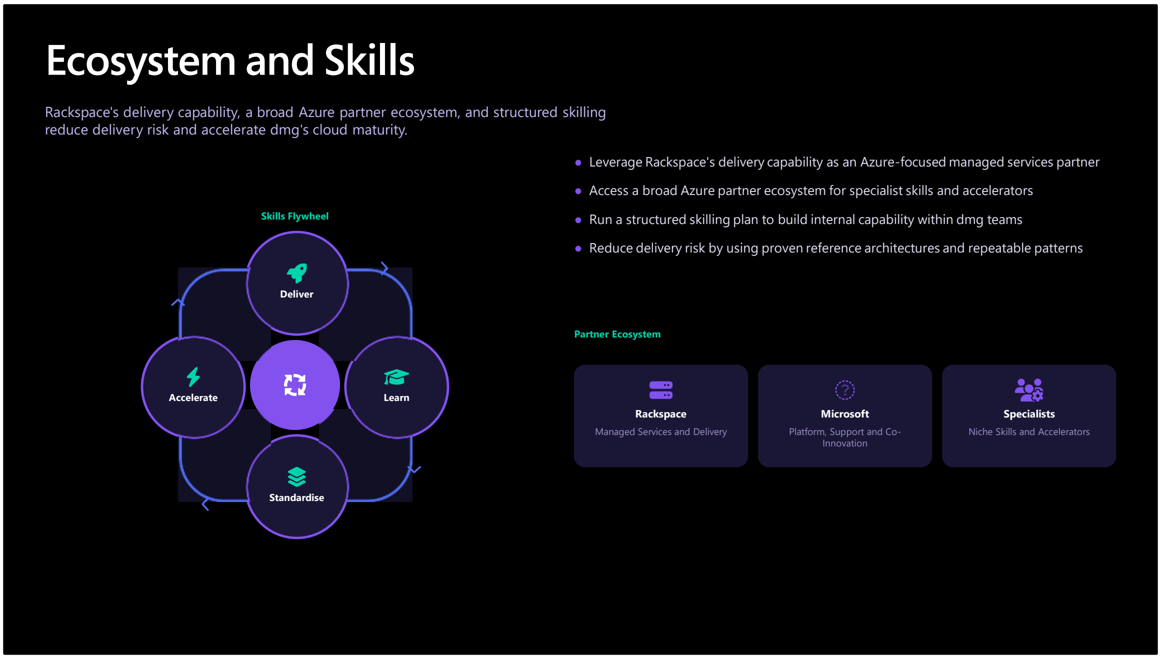


Delivery capacity and skills availability. Rackspace provides Azure-focused delivery at scale, supported by Microsoft and the wider Azure Expert MSP ecosystem.
Specialist partners can be introduced as needed without fragmenting the platform approach. A structured skilling plan builds capability within dmg teams through role-based training and hands-on enablement.
Repeatable patterns and runbooks reduce delivery risk and accelerate maturity.

Commercial Skilling options

Designed for IT Pros, Developers, and Business Users

Scale Skilling for Everyone

Self-Paced Digital

- Learn for Organizations
- Curated Plans on Learn

Events & Workshops

- Microsoft Virtual Training Days
- Learn Challenges

Credentials

- Certifications
- Applied Skills
- Practice Assessments
- Exam Readiness Zone

Videos

- Course Videos for flexible learning

+

ESI Premium Skilling Options

Skilling Plan support across Microsoft's skilling ecosystem via Training Program Managers (TPMs)

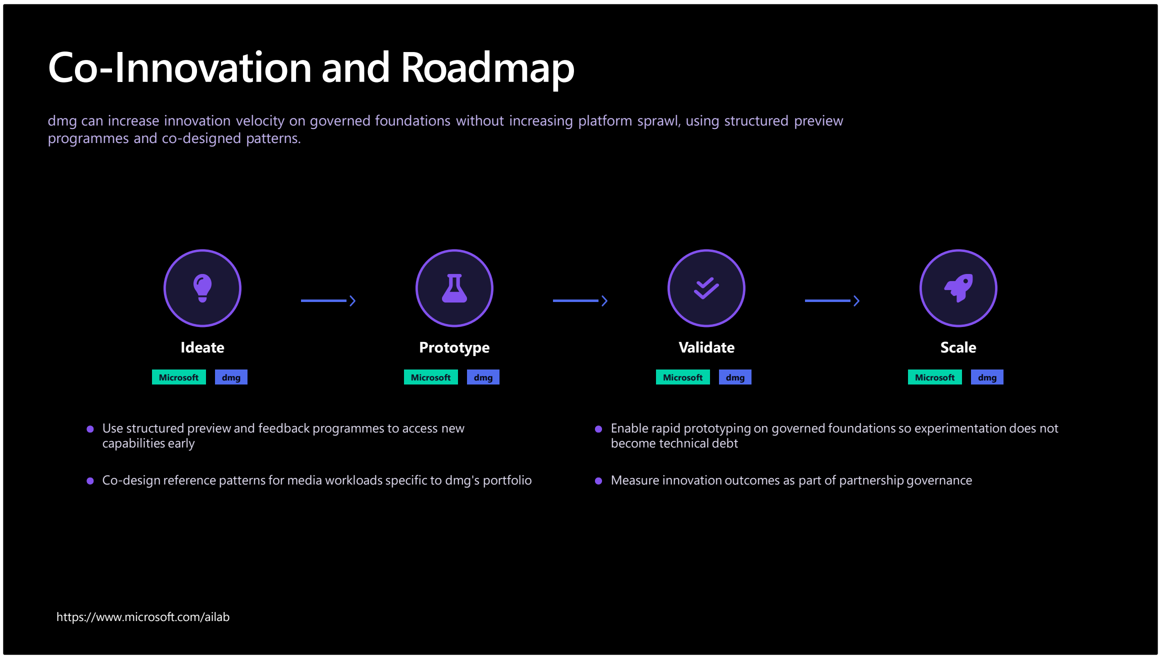
Instructor-led Training (ILT) via Microsoft Technical Trainers (MTTs)

Training Services Partner vouchers (TSPs)

Learning portals (Learner Experience Portal, Customer Experience Portal)

Certification Discounts

24x7 ESI Support Desk for questions



This slide outlines how DMG and Microsoft can work together to increase innovation velocity **without increasing platform sprawl or creating long-term technical debt**. The approach is based on innovating on top of **governed, standardised platform foundations**, so that new ideas can be explored quickly while remaining secure, compliant, and reusable across DMG brands.

Innovation is managed through a structured lifecycle that allows teams to move from idea to scale in a controlled and repeatable way:

Ideate

DMG gains early insight into new Microsoft capabilities through **structured preview and feedback programmes**. These programmes allow relevant features to be assessed early, before formal adoption, helping ensure that innovation efforts align to DMG's roadmap and long-term priorities rather than ad-hoc experimentation.

Prototype

Microsoft and DMG **co-design reference patterns** tailored specifically for media and publishing workloads, such as performance, resilience, and automation. Prototypes are built using these patterns so that innovation outputs are reusable across brands and do not result in one-off technical solutions.

Validate

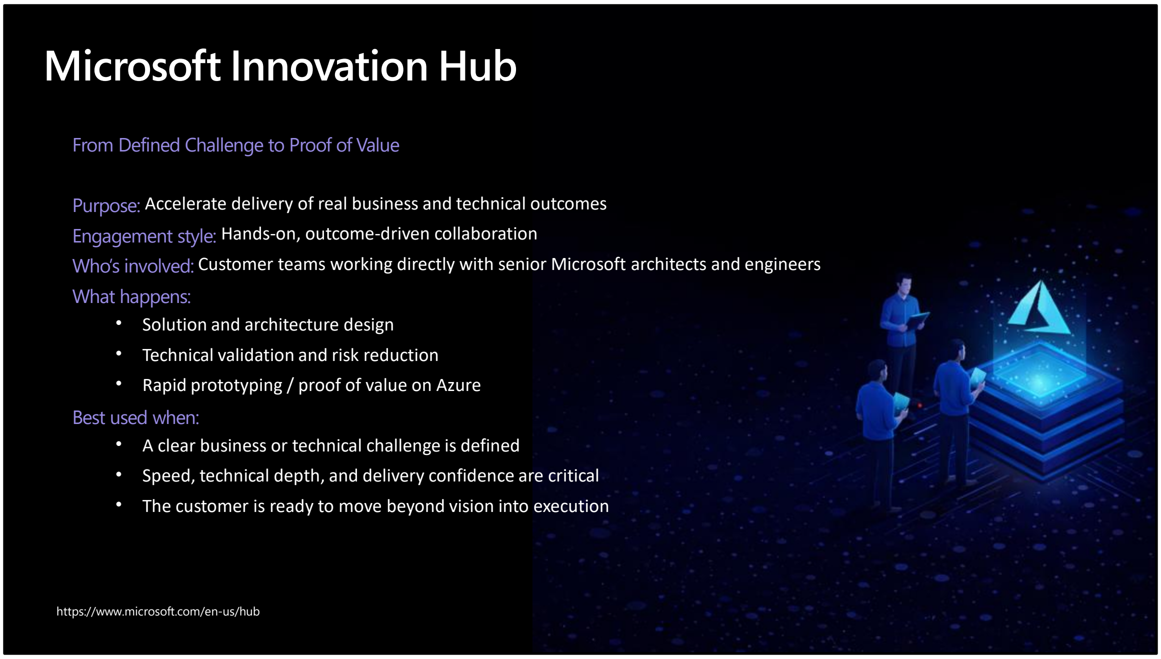
New use cases — including data and AI initiatives — are **rapidly prototyped on governed foundations**. This ensures that security, cost controls, and operational standards are applied from the outset, preventing the creation of parallel platforms that would later require rework before production use.

Scale

Successful ideas are scaled using the same foundations and patterns. Innovation outcomes are tracked through partnership governance, with metrics such as **delivery cycle time, reliability, and unit economics** used to ensure that experimentation translates into measurable business value.

Overall, this model allows DMG to **move fast, learn early, and scale what works**, while maintaining architectural discipline and operational consistency. Innovation becomes a standard, repeatable capability

embedded into the platform — rather than a collection of disconnected pilots.
For additional context on Microsoft’s broader co-innovation programmes, see:
https://www.microsoft.com/ailab



The Microsoft Innovation Hub is designed for customers who want to move from a defined challenge to real progress quickly. It's an **outcome-led, hands-on engagement** where customer teams work directly with **senior Microsoft architects** to go deep on the technical and architectural choices that matter.

The focus is on translating business goals into a clear technical direction — through **business envisioning, solution envisioning, architecture design, and rapid prototyping**. In other words: we align on the "what" and "why", then we validate the "how", and we produce tangible artefacts that help the customer confidently take next steps.

A helpful way to position it is: this isn't a generic workshop — it's a structured engagement that helps customers reduce risk and increase delivery confidence by validating feasibility and approach alongside Microsoft experts. It's typically used **by invitation** for strategic customers, and it's part of a global network of locations.

If you're deciding when to use it: Innovation Hub is ideal when the customer already has a real scenario they care about and wants to accelerate from intent to execution — with Microsoft's technical leadership in the room.

Microsoft Envisioning Centres

Strategic Vision, Alignment, and Direction

Purpose: Align senior leaders on future vision and strategic direction
Engagement style: Executive-led, immersive, and highly curated
Who's involved: Customer leadership teams with Microsoft executives and specialists
What happens:

- Industry-specific storytelling and scenarios
- Demonstrations of what's possible with Microsoft technology
- Facilitated discussions to shape ambition and priorities

Best used when:

- The customer is early in their journey or facing ambiguity
- Executive alignment is needed before technical decisions
- The goal is to inspire, align, and frame transformation

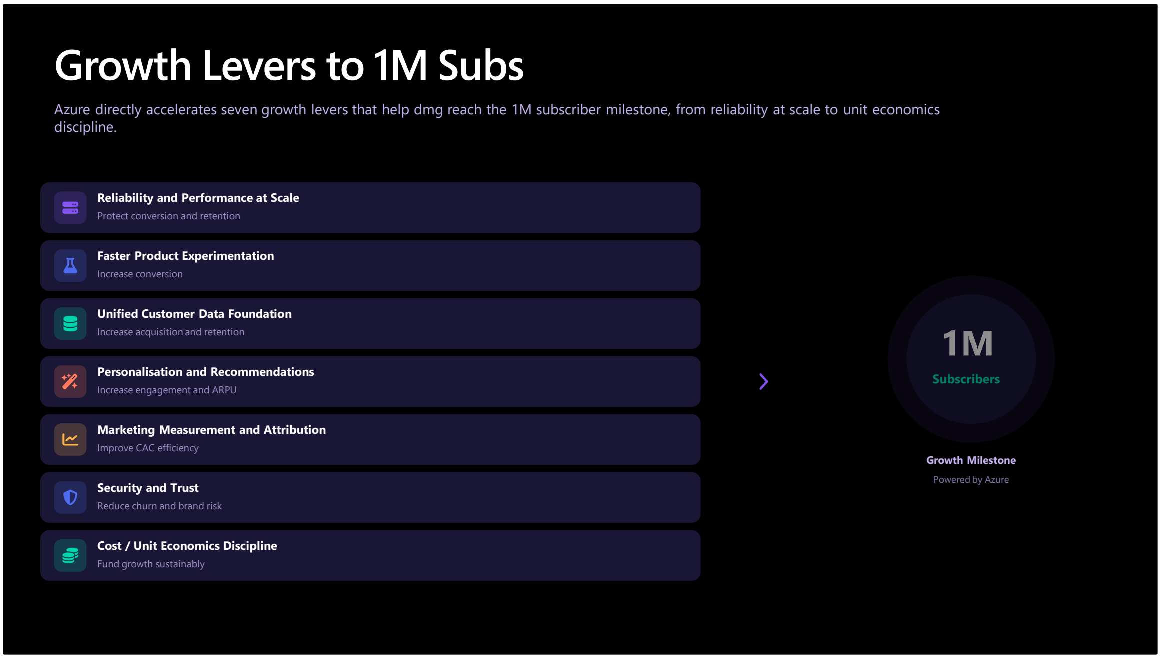
https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/ec

Microsoft's Envisioning Centres sit within our broader **Customer Engagement Programs** — they're designed to help customers progress faster by combining **immersive experiences** with outcome-driven conversations, supported by Microsoft experts in dedicated facilities around the world.

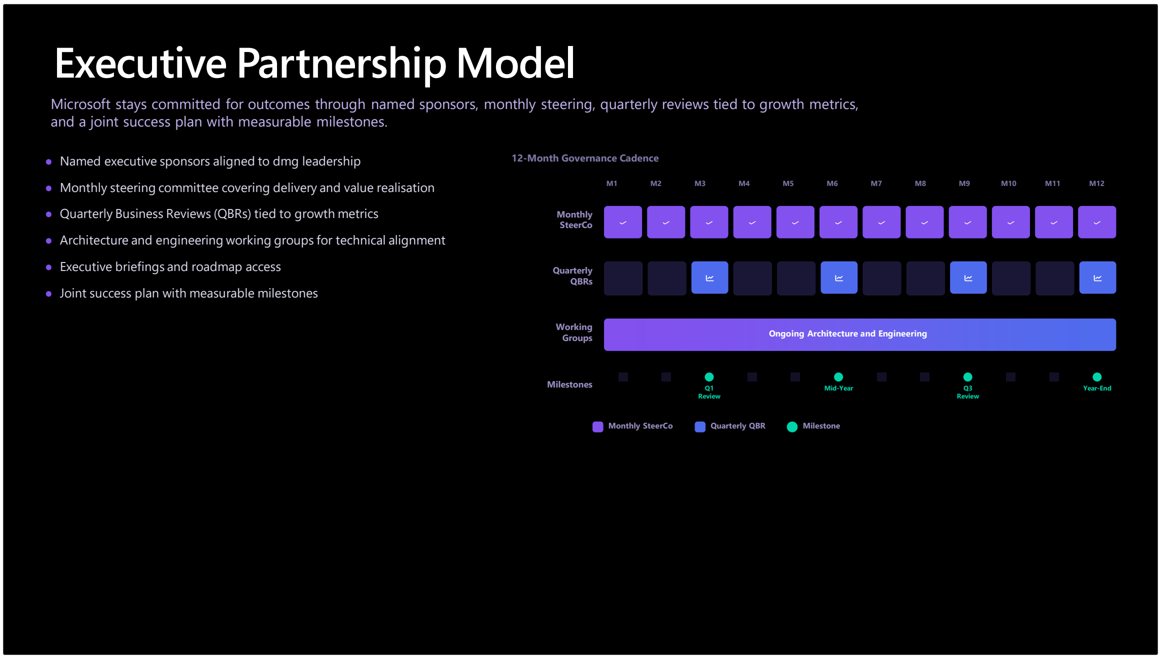
The key distinction versus Innovation Hub is the centre of gravity: Envisioning is about **executive alignment and strategic direction**. It's built to help business and technology leaders step back from day-to-day delivery and align on the future — what's possible, what matters most, and what transformation could look like for their industry and organisation.

Depending on the engagement, this can include an **Executive Briefing Program**, which Microsoft describes as a way to build trust and accelerate outcomes by facilitating knowledge-sharing between customer decision makers and Microsoft leaders and subject matter experts.

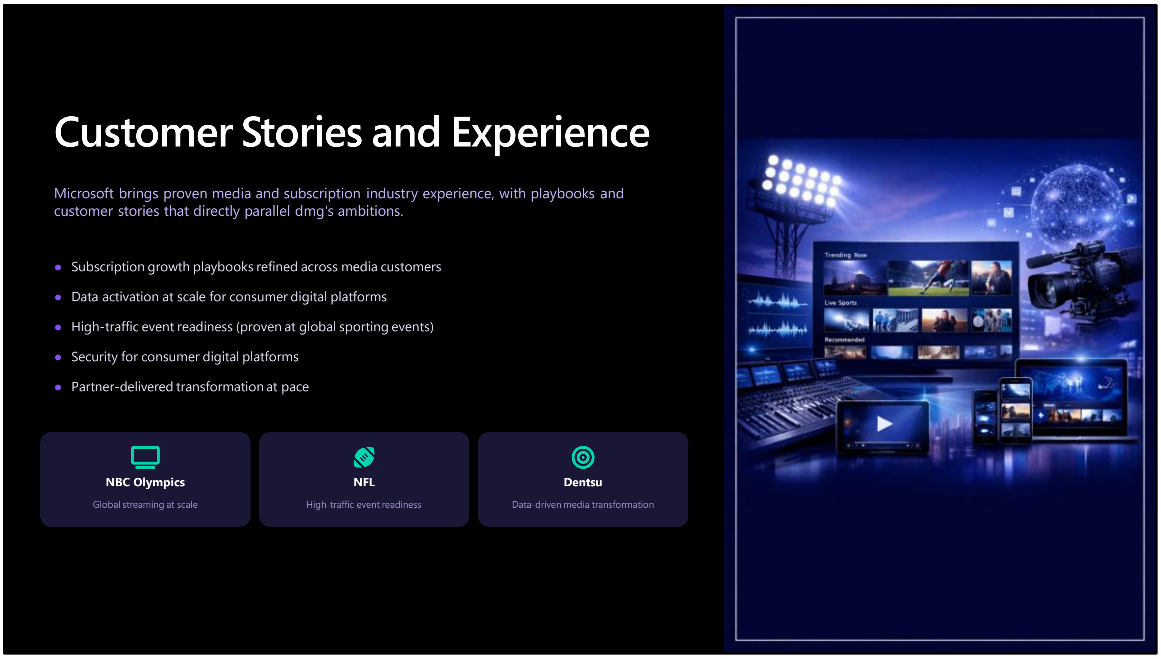
The simplest way to position it to customers is: Envisioning Centres help leadership teams create shared ambition and clarity — before they commit to major technology choices — and then we can move into deeper technical acceleration motions like the Innovation Hub once priorities are set.



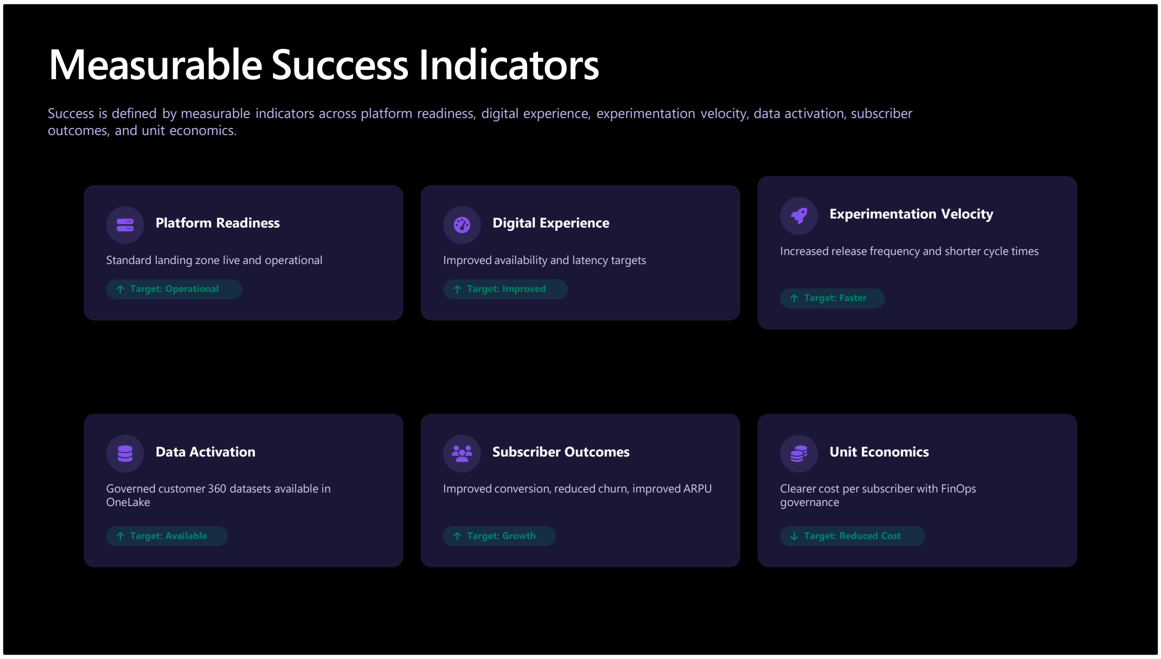
Platform capabilities translates into growth outcomes. Reliability and performance patterns protect conversion and retention during peak events. Automation-first delivery accelerates experimentation across acquisition and onboarding journeys. Unified customer data supports segmentation, personalisation and lifetime value optimisation.
AI enables recommendations, churn prediction and next-best-action offers, while marketing measurement improves CAC efficiency. Security and FinOps ensure growth does not create unacceptable risk or cost.



The Microsoft model for accountability: Named executive sponsors from Microsoft and Rackspace align directly to dmg leadership with a clear escalation path.
Monthly steering committees track delivery, security and cost outcomes, while QBRs focus on growth metrics and roadmap alignment. Engineering working groups ensure reusable patterns are created once and adopted everywhere.
A joint success plan defines shared milestones and ownership across all parties.



Microsoft brings subscription growth playbooks, high-traffic event readiness and large-scale data activation experience.
Examples such as NBC Olympics, NFL and Dentsu demonstrate experience operating at scale, supporting experimentation, and activating data and AI responsibly. These references can be tailored based on dmg preference.



Defining success in measurable terms. Platform readiness, digital experience performance and experimentation velocity track operational maturity.
Data activation and subscriber outcomes measure growth impact, while unit economics ensure sustainability. Together, these indicators provide a clear, objective view of progress towards 1M subscribers.

News AI Customer Stories

As the world's largest provider of news on the desktop, Microsoft has for more than 25 years championed the importance of news to our audience of Windows users. We've collaborated closely with more than 1,200 media publishing partners, who represent more than 4,500 media brands. We distribute their stories via MSN and other Microsoft Start newsfeeds to hundreds of millions of readers in more than 180 countries and 31 languages.

Semafor
AI-enhanced breaking news

- Multi-Source Curation
- AI Assisted Research
- Structured Presentation
- Response to Social

Nota
Developing a custom language model
For newsroom tools

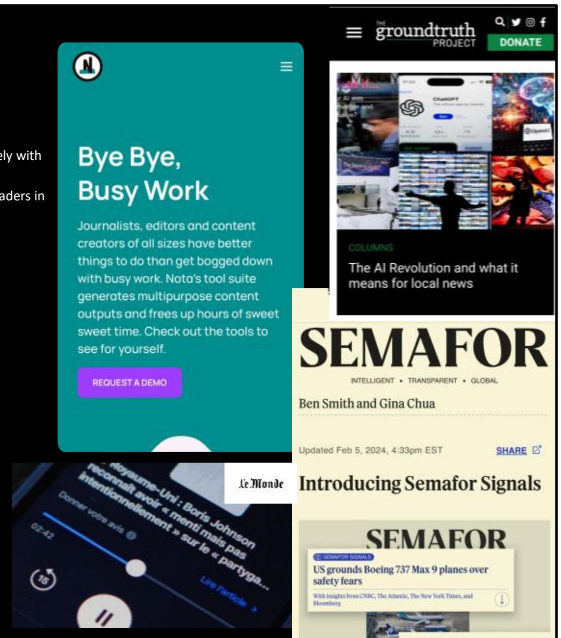
- Editors can refine tone and structure.
- Journalists benefit from faster turnaround and higher engagement.
- Newsrooms can maintain consistency and quality across content.

The Ground Truth Project
Localisation support

- Measure and track adoption attitudes in local newsrooms.
- Centralized project support

Le Monde

- Introducing Audio Articles powered by Azure cognitive services
- AI takes the literary style of Le Monde into account as well as the actors so the algorithm can integrate the full breadth of the paper's writing style.



These examples are provided to demonstrate Microsoft's experience supporting media and publishing organisations with data, AI, and platform modernisation — not to imply a specific solution pattern for DMG.

Microsoft

Premier League

Premier League drives deep fan connection with Microsoft Foundry and Azure Cosmos DB

Customer: Premier League

Industry: Sports and Live Experiences

Size: 50-999 employees

Country: United Kingdom

Publish date: 11/2025

[Watch the full story here]

"We have already had 60 million users across our website and app so far this season. Fans all over the globe are positively engaging with the content being provided to them and enjoying the stories that come off of Premier League pitches up and down the country each match round."

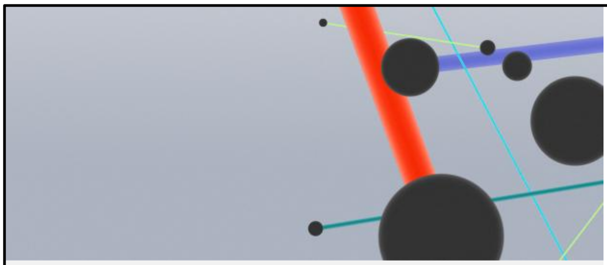
— Will Brass, Chief Commercial Officer, Premier League

Situation: To drive engagement and support personalized and contextually relevant fan experiences, the Premier League envisioned an agile, secure AI platform to connect its global fanbase with its vast compilation of match and team data, videos, and articles.

Solution: The Premier League unified massive, diverse datasets and enabled real-time, personalized fan experiences using Microsoft Azure AI, cloud, and analytics.

Impact: By enabling real-time personalization and rapid innovation, Premier League saw fan engagement rise 20%, with 60 million fans active in early months.

Products: Azure AI Foundry, Azure Cosmos DB, Azure, Azure Data Factory, Azure Databricks, Azure Machine Learning, Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry Models, Azure AI Search, Azure Managed Redis



Microsoft dentsu

Dentsu reduces time to media insights by 90% using Azure AI

Customer: Dentsu
Industry: Telecommunications
Size: 10,000+ employees
Country: United Kingdom
Publish date: 11/2024
Read the full story here

"It was great to get a head start with the scripts that were part of the Azure AI prompt flow template."

— Simon Ransom, Lead DevOps Engineer, Dentsu

Situation: Sophisticated media planning and budget optimizations require expertise from teams of data scientists and media analysts. But with insights taking weeks, Dentsu teams and clients needed faster answers and more self-service options.

Solution: Dentsu developers used Microsoft Azure AI Foundry and Azure OpenAI Service to build a predictive analytics copilot that uses conversational chat and draws on deep expertise in media forecasting, budgeting, and optimizations.

Impact: The new agent makes media insights available to more Dentsu employees and clients, cuts time to insight by 90%, and reduces analysis costs.

Products: Azure AI, Azure AI Studio, Azure API Management, Azure Kubernetes Service, Azure Machine Learning, Azure OpenAI Service, Microsoft Visual Studio

ESPN Edge finds a winning digital game plan in an evolving media landscape with Microsoft Azure

ESPN is a multinational sports media company that reached 74 million U.S. television households and averaged 108 million digital fans monthly in 2022.

Industry: Media & Comms

Size: Corporate (10,000+ employees)

Products: Microsoft Azure, Azure AI, Azure Analytics

Partners: Accenture, Verizon

Challenges

- ESPN wanted to continue to position itself as an innovative company to separate itself from competitors.
- The company knew that it had to cut through the noise of new media and tap modern technologies to create unparalleled fan experiences.

Solution

- ESPN worked with Microsoft, Accenture, and Verizon to launch the ESPN Edge Innovation Center, which brings together technology, consulting, connectivity, and hardware to develop new ways of experiencing sports.
- By using tools such as Azure AI, ESPN can provide automated, real-time closed captioning.

Impact

- Delivered more than 50% cost savings on closed captioning
- Captioned more content to serve sports fans
- Boosted operating margins
- Increased competitiveness in a changing media landscape

"Our Azure-based closed-captioning product will be at the forefront, providing innovative firsts to sports fans everywhere."

Kevin Lopes, Vice President, Sports Business Development and Innovation at ESPN

Read the Microsoft Customer Story

Microsoft

Customer:
Nota
Industry:
Media and Entertainment
Size:
1–49 employees
Country:
United States
Products and services:
Microsoft Azure
Azure OpenAI Service
Azure Machine Learning
Azure API Management

[Read full story here]

Microsoft

"Microsoft has shown us that we don't have to be a gigantic organization with a huge research and development lab to make exciting and meaningful AI applications."
—Josh Brandau, Chief Executive Officer, Nota

Situation:

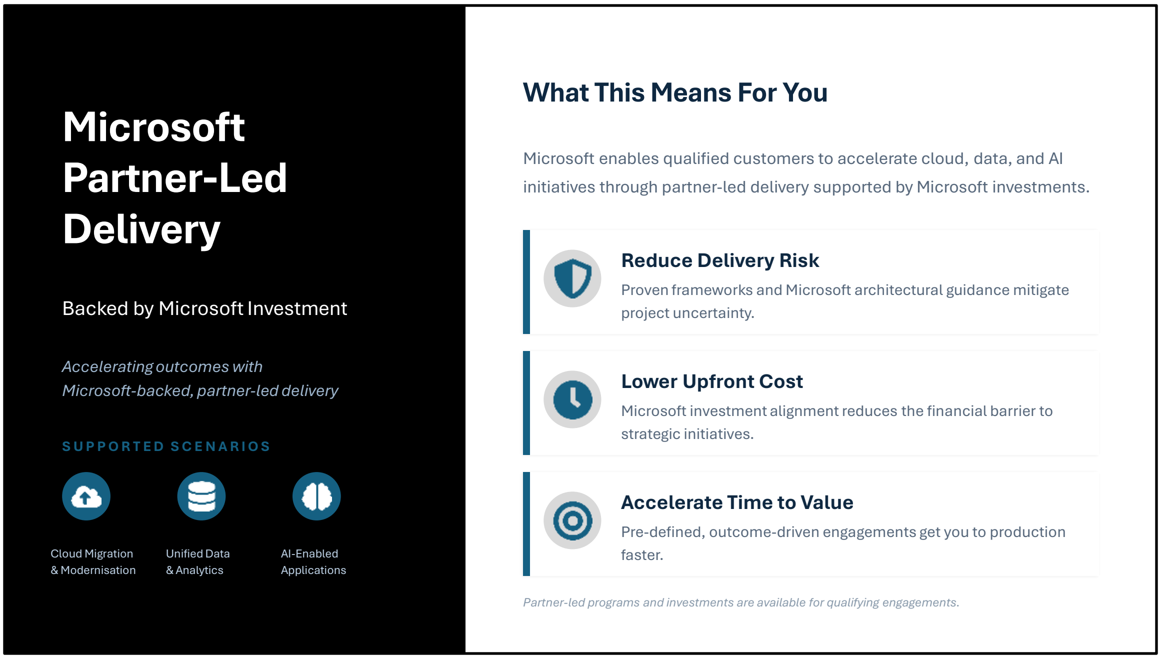
To help struggling local newsrooms across America, Nota wanted to develop AI-assisted tools to help with a lot of the non-writing work that takes up much of journalists' time and pulls them away from their core job of investigating and reporting on the news.

Solution:

After connecting with the Microsoft for Startups Founders Hub, Nota saw the power of Azure OpenAI Service and has used it to create two applications that optimize written stories for social media distribution and turn those stories into engaging videos.

Impact:

User feedback during beta development has been extremely positive, and Nota has attracted the attention of many newsrooms—large and small. The company plans to build on its success with more solutions to help local journalists excel.



Overview of the Program

This slide introduces Microsoft's **Partner-Led Delivery** model—an approach where Microsoft works closely with certified partners to accelerate customer outcomes.

Emphasize that this model is **backed by Microsoft investment**, helping qualified customers move faster with reduced financial and delivery risk.

Purpose and Value

The key message: customers can benefit from **Microsoft-backed, partner-led execution**, combining best-in-class delivery capability with Microsoft's architectural oversight and funding support.

This approach is especially powerful for organizations that want to progress quickly but need support to de-risk or scale their initiatives.

Supported Scenarios

Highlight the three focus areas shown at the bottom of the slide:

Cloud Migration & Modernisation

Support for moving workloads to Azure and modernizing legacy systems.

Unified Data & Analytics

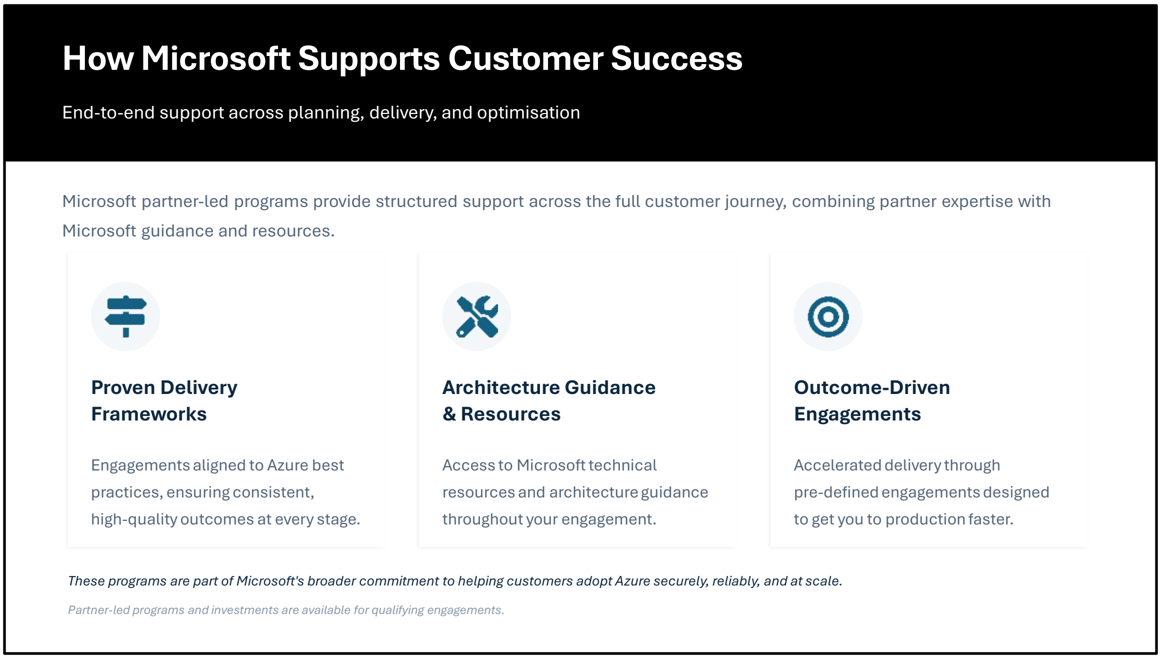
Enabling customers to build scalable, integrated data platforms to drive insights.

AI-Enabled Applications

Helping customers adopt and deploy AI solutions using proven practices.

Key Takeaway

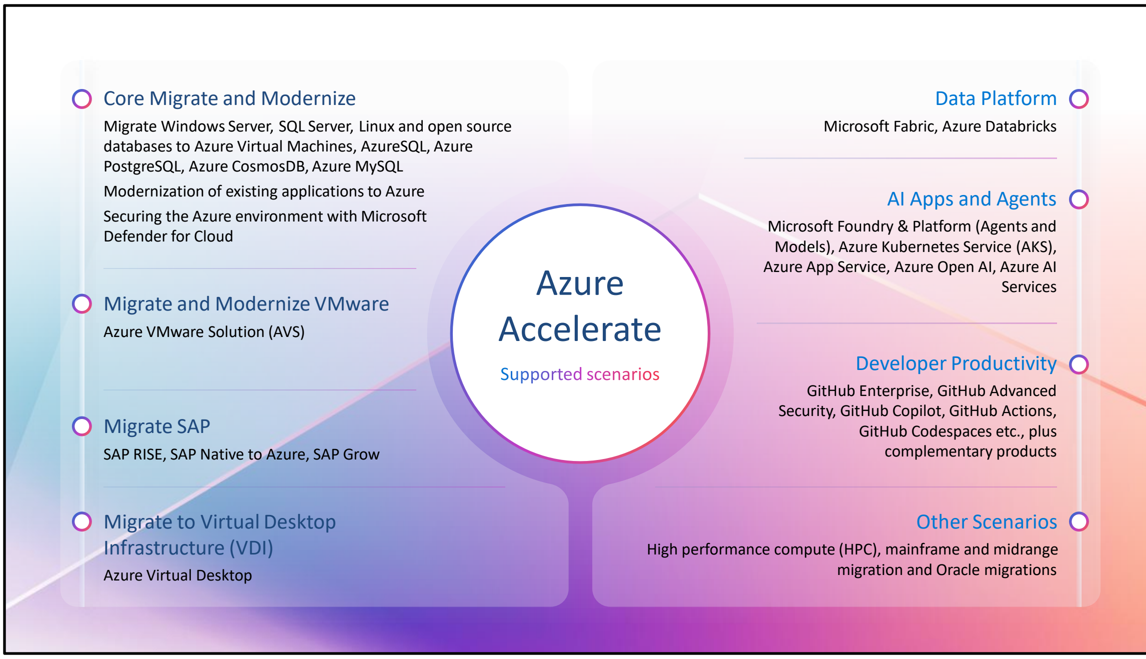
This slide sets the stage: *Microsoft helps accelerate outcomes by investing in partner-delivered engagements* so customers can unlock value faster with less risk.



This slide explains the **direct benefits to the customer** when engaging through the partner-led, Microsoft-funded model.
Reinforce that eligible customers can use these programs to accelerate cloud, data, and AI initiatives.

1. Reduce Delivery Risk
Through structured frameworks and Microsoft architectural guidance, projects are more predictable and aligned with best practices.
The combination of vetted partners and Microsoft oversight helps reduce uncertainties in planning, execution, and governance.
2. Lower Upfront Cost
Microsoft contributes investment to offset delivery costs.
This reduces the financial barrier for organizations that want to begin strategic initiatives but are cautious about budget impact.
Stress that *this funding is designed to remove friction and help customers start sooner*.
3. Accelerate Time to Value
Partner-led engagements use **pre-defined, outcome-driven playbooks** that fast-track delivery.

Customers move into production or proof-of-value phases more quickly, helping them realise business benefits earlier.
Useful especially for AI and data scenarios where speed is a competitive advantage.



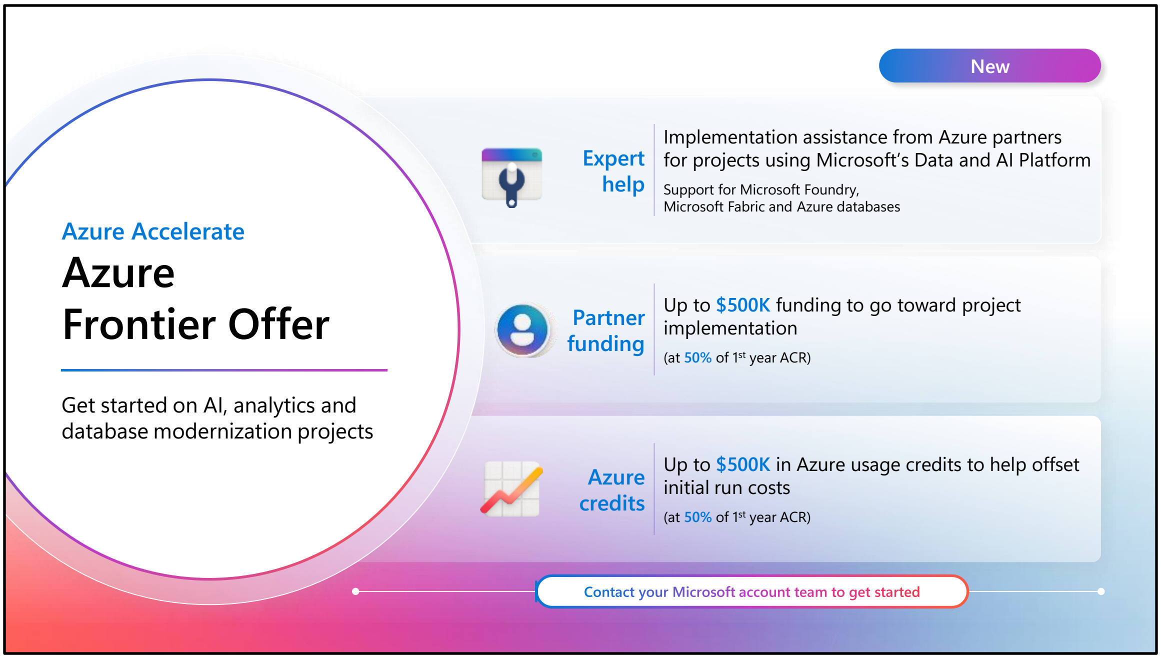
Azure Accelerate supports a wide variety of scenarios across migration, modernization or innovation. Let's touch on some key scenarios:

- **Core Migrate and Modernize:** This is a common starting point for many on their cloud journey. You can migrate existing on-premises workloads or choose to modernize them as you bring them to Azure.
- **Data Platform:** This helps you both modernize your data estate and then follow with building advanced analytics solutions
- **AI Apps and Agents:** This will help you reimagine your existing apps to infuse them with AI capabilities or to build entirely new AI-enabled apps

These three scenarios are where we see a lot of our customers taking advantage of Azure Accelerate benefits. There are many more ways we can help including:

- Migrating your VMware environment
- SAP projects
- Migrating to a VDI solution hosted in Azure
- Setting up your developers to be more productive with tools like GitHub

Available to qualifying customers through Microsoft-approved Azure Accelerate engagements.



Available to qualifying customers through Microsoft-approved Azure Accelerate engagements.

Available via Microsoft field nomination only

Azure Accelerate

Additional purpose built offers for specific workloads and situations

Core Migrate and Modernize (and Incubation for cross Solution Play support)				
Offers | Project size	Engagement activities	Partner funding	Azure credits	Engagement assistance
Azure VMware (Partner funding) >$500K/year ACR Azure VMware Solution credits Any project size	Planning activities, including assessment or proof of value Implementation activities related to the stated workloads	Up to $500K (Implement) (at 33% of 1st year ACR)	Up to $350K (available for net new migrations only)	Partner and Microsoft CSU delivered
SAP RISE (partner funding) >$50K ACR (for 3 years) SAP Azure Credit offer >$100K ACR (for 3 years)	• Extend & Innovate proof of value • Implementation activities for migrating to SAP RISE	Up to $50K (Plan) Up to $500K (Implement) (at 33% of 3-year ACR)	Up to $150K (at 33% of 3-year Reserved Instance value)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
Oracle Database@Azure offer >$100K/year ACR	• Planning activities, including assessment or proof of value • Implementation activities related to deploying Oracle Database @Azure	Up to $50K (Plan) (Assessments capped at $20K) Up to $500K (Implement) (at 33% of 1st year ACR)	N/A	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
Incubation workloads For HPC, mainframe/midrange and DevOps/Dev Box scenarios >$50K/year ACR	• Planning activities, including proof of value • Implementation activities related to the stated workloads	Up to $100K (Plan or Implement) (at 20% of 1st year ACR)	Up to $100K (at 10% of 1st year ACR)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered

Azure Accelerate has a group of offers that are built for specific scenarios/workloads or situations. These offers should be considered if you have:

- Specific scenarios (e.g. VMware or SAP RISE) and you'd like to take advantage of additional funding being offered
- Specific situations (e.g. you need end-to-end help on your AI transformation or one of Microsoft's competitors has provided a competing offer)

The following two slides show these offers broken out 3 categories – 1) Migrate and Modernize, 2) AI Apps, Agents and Developer and 3) Data Platform
Your Microsoft account team can nominate you for any of these offers.

Available to qualifying customers through Microsoft-approved Azure Accelerate engagements.

Available via Microsoft field nomination only

Azure Accelerate

Additional purpose built offers for specific workloads and situations

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Incubation workloads For HPC, mainframe/midrange and DevOps/Dev Box scenarios >$50K/year ACR	• Planning activities, including proof of value • Implementation activities related to the stated workloads	Up to $100K (Plan or Implement) (at 20% of 1st year ACR)	Up to $100K (at 10% of 1st year ACR)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered

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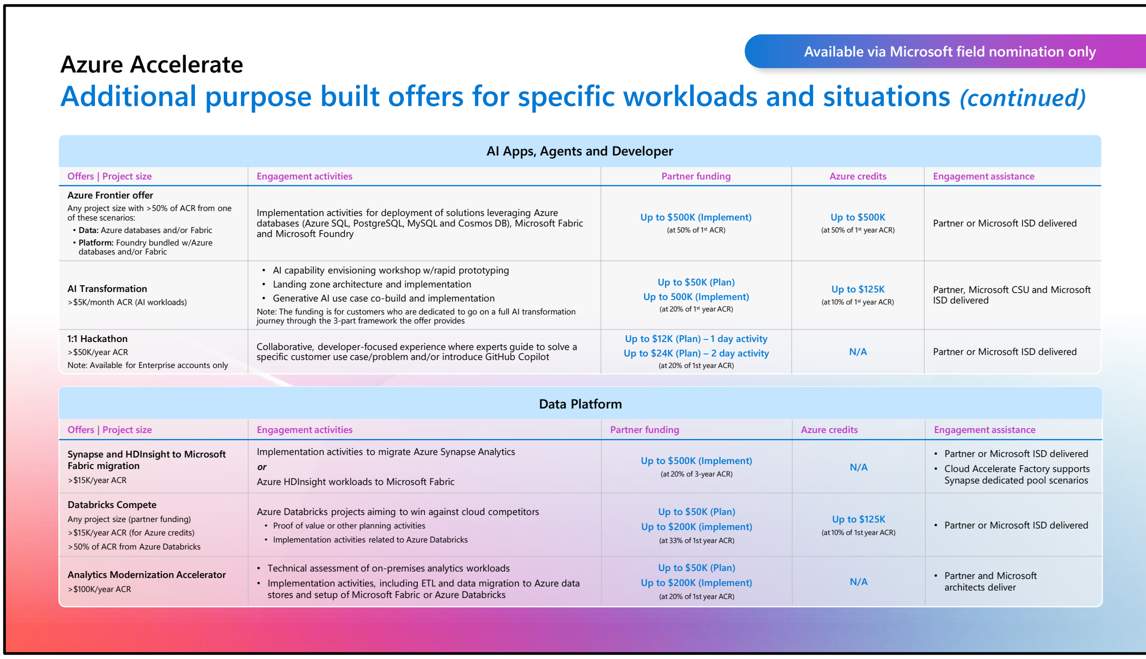

Available via Microsoft field nomination only

Azure Accelerate

Additional purpose built offers for specific workloads and situations *(continued)*

AI Apps, Agents and Developer

Offers | Project size	Engagement activities	Partner funding	Azure credits	Engagement assistance
Azure Frontier offer Any project size with >50% of ACR from one of these scenarios: • **Data:** Azure databases and/or Fabric • **Platform:** Foundry bundled w/Azure databases and/or Fabric	Implementation activities for deployment of solutions leveraging Azure databases (Azure SQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL and Cosmos DB), Microsoft Fabric and Microsoft Foundry	Up to $500K (Implement) (at 50% of 1st ACR)	Up to $500K (at 50% of 1st year ACR)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
AI Transformation >$5K/month ACR (AI workloads)	• AI capability envisioning workshop w/rapid prototyping • Landing zone architecture and implementation • Generative AI use case co-build and implementation Note: The funding is for customers who are dedicated to go on a full AI transformation journey through the 3-part framework the offer provides	Up to $50K (Plan) Up to 500K (Implement) (at 20% of 1st year ACR)	Up to $125K (at 10% of 1st year ACR)	Partner, Microsoft CSU and Microsoft ISD delivered
1:1 Hackathon >$50K/year ACR Note: Available for Enterprise accounts only	Collaborative, developer-focused experience where experts guide to solve a specific customer use case/problem and/or introduce GitHub Copilot	Up to $12K (Plan) – 1 day activity Up to $24K (Plan) – 2 day activity (at 20% of 1st year ACR)	N/A	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered

Data Platform

Offers | Project size	Engagement activities	Partner funding	Azure credits	Engagement assistance
Synapse and HDInsight to Microsoft Fabric migration >$15K/year ACR	Implementation activities to migrate Azure Synapse Analytics ***or*** Azure HDInsight workloads to Microsoft Fabric	Up to $500K (Implement) (at 20% of 3-year ACR)	N/A	• Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered • Cloud Accelerate Factory supports Synapse dedicated pool scenarios
Databricks Compete Any project size (partner funding) >$15K/year ACR (for Azure credits) >50% of ACR from Azure Databricks	Azure Databricks projects aiming to win against cloud competitors • Proof of value or other planning activities • Implementation activities related to Azure Databricks	Up to $50K (Plan) Up to $200K (implement) (at 33% of 1st year ACR)	Up to $125K (at 10% of 1st year ACR)	• Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
Analytics Modernization Accelerator >$100K/year ACR	• Technical assessment of on-premises analytics workloads • Implementation activities, including ETL and data migration to Azure data stores and setup of Microsoft Fabric or Azure Databricks	Up to $50K (Plan) Up to $200K (Implement) (at 20% of 1st year ACR)	N/A	• Partner and Microsoft architects deliver

Available to qualifying customers through Microsoft-approved Azure Accelerate engagements.